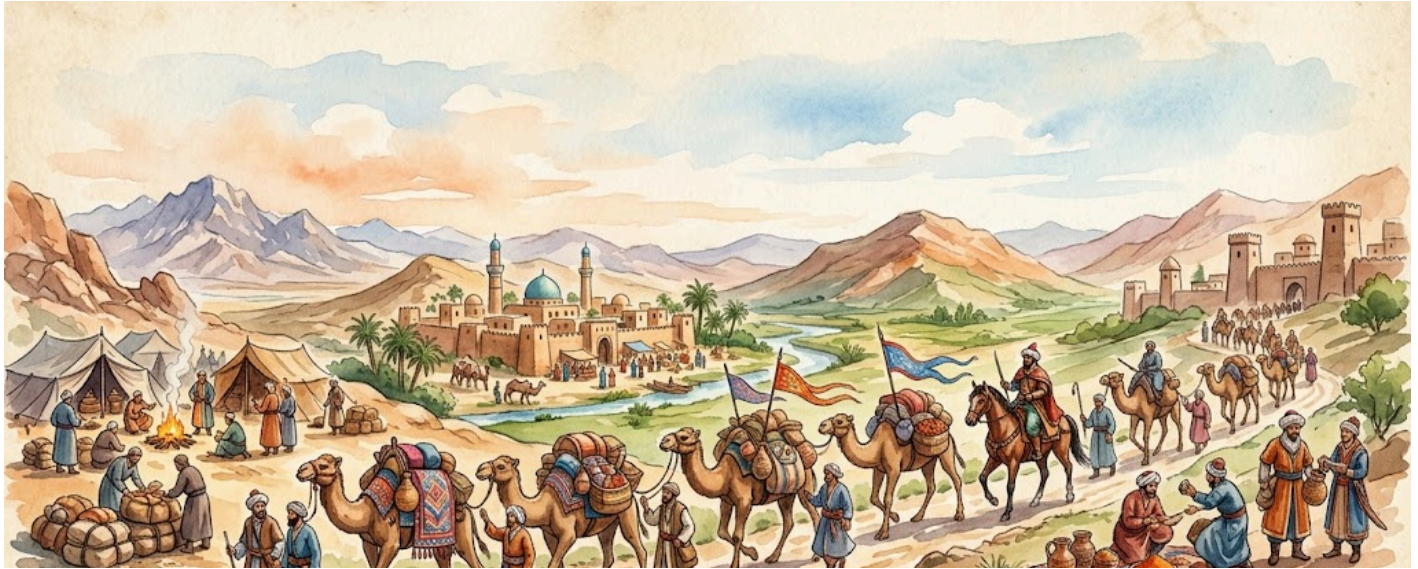




# Cover Page and Vocab

# My Silk Road Journey

*A story about trade, travel, and solving problems*



## You are a storyteller.

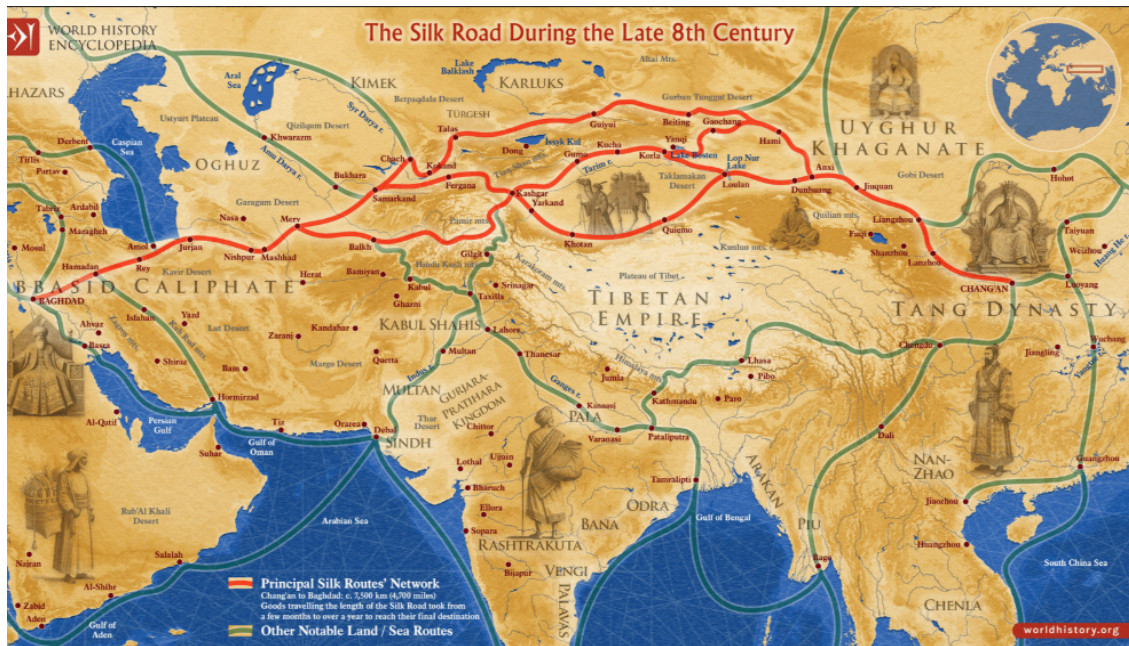
*Tell the story of a merchant's journey along the Silk Road — the people, the problems, the choices, and what trade changed.*

|               |  |
|---------------|--|
| <b>Name:</b>  |  |
| <b>Class:</b> |  |
| <b>Date:</b>  |  |

*Your assessment for Social Studies AND English.*

# 1 Part 1-The Beginning

## Plan Your Story



## Example Locations Along the Silk Road:

**Chang'an (modern-day Xi'an)**- Often journeys started here and they had to move through a narrow string of Oases squeezed between the massive Tibetan Plateau to the south and the Gobi Desert to the north.

**Samarkand, Uzbekistan (The Jewel of the Road)** Located right in the middle of the Silk Road, this city became incredibly wealthy. It was famous for its blue-tiled buildings and its "Golden Market."

**The Gobi and Taklamakan Deserts**- Travellers skirted around the outside of the Gobi and the Taklamakan deserts staying in Caravanserai's to stay safe.

**Baghdad, Iraq (The Center of Learning)**- During the Golden Age of Islam, Baghdad was a circular city and a massive hub for science and math.

**The Pamir Mountains**- These dangerous, icy mountains were one of the most dangerous segments of the route. Caravans had to cross passes as high as 4,600 meters (15,000 feet). Oxygen is thin, and the weather is unpredictable.

| Start of journey | Stop 1 | Stop 2 | Destination |
|------------------|--------|--------|-------------|
|                  |        |        |             |

## Plan Your Story

Before you write, plan WHO your story is about and WHY they are going.

**1. Character Name** *e.g. Mei, Hassan, Li*

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**2. Character Role: (trader / merchant / young helper / caravan leader)** *Choose one or write your own.*

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**3. Homeland:** *e.g. Chang'an (China), Samarkand, Kashgar, Baghdad*

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**4. Destination** *e.g. Persia, India, Rome, the western marketplace*

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**5. My character trades (choose 3):** *e.g. silk, tea, spices, jade, paper, gold*

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**6. WHY is my character going?** *(CAUSE — e.g. family needs money / silk is valuable far away)*

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## Write Your Beginning

**WRITE HERE — use any of these starters. You can change the words.**

- Long ago, in the year ..., I was a ...
- I lived in the city of ...
- I wanted to travel to ... because ...
- I packed my caravan with ...
- I knew the journey would be hard, but ...

*Write here*

## 2 Part 2-The Middle Challenges

## Write Problem 1 (Local)

### CHOOSE A LOCAL PROBLEM (your caravan only):

☐ Sandstorm    ☐ Steep mountain pass    ☐ Bandits on the road

### WRITE HERE — use any of these starters. You can change the words.

- After ... (days / weeks), we faced a problem.
- I felt ... because ...
- I said to ..., "..."
- I knew that IF we did not ..., we MIGHT ...
- SO we decided to ...
- AS A RESULT, ...

After weeks, we faced a problem....

## Write Problem 2 (A Bigger Problem)

### CHOOSE A BIGGER PROBLEM (between countries / regions):

☐ War between kingdoms    ☐ Language barrier at the marketplace    ☐ Getting lost — route washed away

### WRITE HERE — use any of these starters. You can change the words.

- Many days later, we faced an even bigger problem.
- I felt ..., like ... (simile)
- I whispered to ..., "..."
- I knew that IF we ..., we MIGHT ...
- SO we made an alliance with ... / we worked together with ...
- AS A RESULT, ...

*Write here*

## 3 Part 3-The End/Add Polish

## SESSION 3 — Write Your Ending

**WRITE HERE — use any of these starters. You can change the words.**

- Finally, after ... (weeks / months), we arrived in ...
- The marketplace was ...
- We traded our ... for ...
- BECAUSE OF journeys like mine, ... spread from ... to ...
- I learned that ...

*Write here*

## SESSION 3 — Polish Your Story

### ADD 1 SENSORY DETAIL TO EACH PARAGRAPH

|                     |                                                        |
|---------------------|--------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>I SAW...</b>     | golden sand, tall mountains, busy market, shining silk |
| <b>I HEARD...</b>   | wind howling, camels grunting, voices shouting         |
| <b>I FELT...</b>    | burning sun, cold wind, rough rope, smooth silk        |
| <b>I SMELLED...</b> | spices, smoke, hot bread, dust, sweat                  |

### ADD AT LEAST 1 SIMILE TO YOUR STORY

- The desert was as hot as a fire.
- The wind was as strong as ten horses.
- My heart was beating like a drum.
- The mountain stood tall like a giant.
- The marketplace was as busy as a beehive.

### Check and Fix

|                         |                                                          |
|-------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Dialogue:</b>        | "Let's go," she said. ✓    vs    Lets go she said ✗      |
| <b>Capitals:</b>        | Names + places + 'I' + first word of sentence.           |
| <b>Adjective order:</b> | three small wooden boxes ✓    wooden three small boxes ✗ |

## My Self-Assessment

Tick the box that best fits your story.

| Criterion                                                        | Yes ✓                    | Almost                   | Not Yet                  |
|------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------|--------------------------|--------------------------|
| My story has a Beginning, two Problems, and an End.              | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| My Beginning shows WHY my character is travelling.               | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| Each problem shows a STRATEGY and a PREDICTION (if... might...). | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| My End shows what trade CHANGED (the EFFECT).                    | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| I added sensory details (saw / heard / felt / smelled).          | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| I included dialogue with quotation marks.                        | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| I used transition words (first, then, suddenly, finally).        | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| I wrote at least one simile.                                     | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| I checked my capitals and full stops.                            | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> |



### Now copy out your full story.

Put your four paragraphs together. You can:

- Make a [final copy](#) of your story

*Hand in BOTH this booklet AND your final story.*



Final Copy

# Story Title

*Written by:*

*Add your final writing here*



# Rubric for Teacher Use

## Rubric

(Taken from Atlas 25/05/26)

### ELA Rubrics

| <b>Standard:</b><br><b>W.4.3 Write narratives to develop real or imagined experiences or events using effective technique, descriptive details, and clear event sequences.</b><br><b>W.4.3.a Orient the reader by establishing a situation and introducing a narrator and/or characters; organize an event sequence that unfolds naturally.</b> |                                                                                                                                                      |                                                                                                                                                                               |                                                                                                                                                                                                  |  |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--|
| Exceeding                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       | Meeting                                                                                                                                              | Approaching                                                                                                                                                                   | Emerging                                                                                                                                                                                         |  |
| A. <b>Clearly</b> oriented the reader by establishing a situation and introducing a narrator and/or characters; organized an event sequence that unfolds naturally.                                                                                                                                                                             | A. Oriented the reader by establishing a situation and introducing a narrator and/or characters; organized an event sequence that unfolds naturally. | A. <b>Somewhat</b> oriented the reader by establishing a situation and introducing a narrator and/or characters; <b>the event sequence may have been illogical in places.</b> | A. <b>Struggled to</b> orient the reader by establishing a situation and introducing a narrator and/or characters; <b>and/or struggled to</b> organize an event sequence that unfolds naturally. |  |

| <b>Standard: W.4.3.b Use dialogue and description to develop experiences and events or show the responses of characters to situations.</b>                              |                                                                                                                       |                                                                                                                                                                                         |                                                                                                                                          |         |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------|
| Exceeding                                                                                                                                                               | Meeting                                                                                                               | Approaching                                                                                                                                                                             | Emerging                                                                                                                                 | Not Met |
| B. Used dialogue and description <b>and other narrative techniques like pacing</b> to develop experiences and events or show the responses of characters to situations. | B. Used dialogue and description to develop experiences and events or show the responses of characters to situations. | B. Used dialogue and description to <b>partially</b> develop experiences and events or show the responses of characters to situations, <b>although these may not always be logical.</b> | B. <b>Struggled to</b> use dialogue and description to develop experiences and events or show the responses of characters to situations. |         |

| <b>Standard: W.4.3.c Use a variety of transitional words and phrases to manage the sequence of events.</b> |                                             |                                           |                                                   |         |
|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------|---------|
| Exceeding                                                                                                  | Meeting                                     | Approaching                               | Emerging                                          | Not Met |
| C. <b>Effectively</b> used a variety of transitional words                                                 | C. Used a variety of transitional words and | C. Used transitional words and phrases to | C. <b>Struggled to</b> use transitional words and |         |

|                                               |                                           |                                                                                    |                                           |  |
|-----------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------|--|
| and phrases to manage the sequence of events. | phrases to manage the sequence of events. | manage the sequence of events, <b>but may have misused them or lacked variety.</b> | phrases to manage the sequence of events. |  |
|-----------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------|--|

**Standard:W.4.3.d Use concrete words and phrases and sensory details to convey experiences and events precisely.**

**W.4.3.e Provide a conclusion that follows from the narrated experiences or events.**

| Exceeding                                                                                                             | Meeting                                                                                            | Approaching                                                                                                          | Emerging                                                                                                              | Not Met |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------|
| D. <b>Effectively</b> used concrete words and phrases and sensory details to convey experiences and events precisely. | D. Used concrete words and phrases and sensory details to convey experiences and events precisely. | D. Used concrete words and phrases and sensory details to convey experiences and events <b>with general clarity.</b> | D. <b>Struggled to</b> use concrete words and phrases and sensory details to convey experiences and events precisely. |         |

## Social Studies Rubrics

**Standard: D2.His.14.3-5. Explain probable causes and effects of events and developments.**

| Exceeding                                                                                                                | Meeting                                                                                                        | Approaching                                                                                                                           | Emerging                                                                                                                                    | Not Met |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------|
| Explains <b>multiple</b> probable causes and effects of events and developments <b>with clear and logical reasoning.</b> | <b>Adequately</b> explains probable causes and effects of events and developments <b>with clear reasoning.</b> | <b>Partially</b> explain probable causes and effects of events and developments with <b>some inaccuracies and flaws in reasoning.</b> | <b>Attempts to</b> Explain probable causes and effects of events and developments <b>with multiple inaccuracies and flaws in reasoning.</b> |         |

**Glossary**

**D4.7.3-5. Explain different strategies and approaches students and others could take in working alone and together to address local, regional, and global problems, and predict possible results of their actions.**

| Exceeding                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 | Meeting                                                                                                                                                                                                                              | Approaching                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              | Emerging                                                                                                                                                                                                                             | Not Met |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------|
| <p><b>Clearly</b> explains the different strategies and approaches to address <b>local, regional AND global</b> problems and <b>thoughtfully</b> predicts the possible results from these actions <b>with strong supporting details and evidence.</b></p> | <p><b>Adequately</b> explains the different strategies and approaches to address a <b>local, regional, AND global</b> problems and predicts the possible results from these actions <b>with supporting details and evidence.</b></p> | <p><b>Somewhat</b> explains the different strategies and approaches to address local, regional, <b>and/or</b> global problems and <b>makes predictions</b> about the possible results, <b>but the explanation may address only two different problems and/or lack detail, evidence or reasoning.</b></p> | <p><b>Attempts to</b> explain the different strategies and approaches to address a local, regional, <b>OR</b> global problem and <b>offers basic predictions</b> about the possible results, with little explanation or support.</p> |         |
| Glossary                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |         |
|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |         |